

PRACTICE TEST FOR ENGLISH MAJORS

Topic: Literature

INSTRUCTION: Use your better judgment to select the best answer.

1. Who wrote the epics Iliad and Odyssey?
 - a. Virgil
 - b. Homer**
 - c. Chaucer
 - d. Valmiki

2. In the epic Iliad, who is the most trusted friend of Achilles?
 - a. Hector
 - b. Patroclus**
 - c. Agamemnon
 - d. Paris

3. The Iliad ends with the death and funeral of a prince and great warrior of Troy. Who is this warrior?
 - a. Hector**
 - b. Patroclus
 - c. Agamemnon
 - d. Paris

4. Who is the **Greek** goddess of wisdom?
 - a. Athena**
 - b. Minerva
 - c. Hera
 - d. Venus

5. In this tragedy, the boy thought that his lover was devoured by a lioness and so he stabbed himself under the mulberry tree. When the girl found her mortally wounded lover, she took her own life and lay sprawled next to him. Their story became the basis for the legend of the mulberry fruit which was previously white but turned black. Who were these lovebirds?
 - a. Pepe and Pilar
 - b. Helen and Paris
 - c. Pyramus and Thisbe**
 - d. Romeo and Juliet



6. Shakespeare's tragic love story about two star-crossed lovers was taken from this much older tale
- Pepe and Pilar
 - Helen and Paris
 - Pyramus and Thisbe
 - Romeo and Juliet
7. The Sanskrit word "guru" means [gu is 'darkness' and ru is 'destroyer']
- removing the ignorance [destroyer of darkness]
 - someone who has mastery over the subject matter
 - none of the above
 - all of the above
8. Mark Twain's novel Tom Sawyer and Huckleberry Finn are set in the _____ river.
- Nile
 - Mississippi
 - Amazon
 - Rio Grande
9. What figure of speech is used in the sentence below? "I am so hungry I can eat a whole elephant!"
- Simile
 - Metaphor
 - Personification
 - Hyperbole
10. "She is a star in the heavens above." What figure of speech is used?
- Simile
 - Metaphor
 - Personification
 - Hyperbole
11. This Indian writer, who wrote the two epics "Shakuntala" and "Raghuvansham," is said to be the counterpart of William Shakespeare, although the latter never wrote epics.
- Tagore
 - Kalidasa
 - Valmiki
 - Vyasa



12. Who wrote the short story "A Rose for Emily"?
- a. William Faulkner
 - b. Emily Dickinson
 - c. Virginia Woolf
 - d. Mary Shelley
13. A sonnet has 14 iambic pentameter lines which means that:
- a. There are 10 syllables in a line
 - b. There are 5 syllables in a line
 - c. There are 8 syllables in a line
 - d. There are 11 syllables in a line
14. Who wrote the short story "Magnificence" which is about a girl who was abused by an older man.
- a. Estrella Alfon
 - b. Kerima Tuvera
 - c. Nick Joaquin
 - d. Appositive
15. What is the pen name of Samuel Clemens?
- a. Mark Twain
 - b. George Orwell
 - c. D.H Lawrence
 - d. T.S Eliot
16. Who wrote the novel Pride and Prejudice?
- a. Jane Austen
 - b. Charlotte Bronte
 - c. Ann Bradstreet
 - d. Edith Wharton
17. Leo Tolstoy's short story about a man who was falsely judged and accused of murder is entitled _____.
- a. Murder
 - b. God Sees The Truth but Waits
 - c. The Killer and the Victim
 - d. The Misjudged
18. Who is considered as the goddess of Philippine poetry?
- a. Ophelia Alcantara Dimalanta
 - b. Teresa Subido



- c. Aida Rivera Ford
- d. Angela Manalang Gloria

19. In the 23rd century BC, Sargon of Akkad conquered Mesopotamia, and became the subject of legends. It is from a Sumerian legend that we learn how Sargon established himself as the cupbearer of the king of Kish in Sumer. What early form of writing did the Sumerians invent?

- a. Cuneiform
- b. Hieroglyphics
- c. Oracle Bone Inscriptions
- d. Native Signs

20. According to research, there are creatures that do not perceive light at the bottom of the sea as they have neither eyes nor ears. Hence, they do not have a concept of day or night. But they have sensory receptors that enable them to feel, and thus find their way around their habitat. This allows them to survive.

By contrast, we humans have eyesight that allows us to see the ground beneath our feet, the heavens above us, as well as the sun, the moon, and stars, sunrise and sunset. Sight shows us day and night. With our sense of hearing, we are able to hear voices, the sound of the sea, and music. Our other sensory organs enable us to feel, taste and smell.

The preceding narrative encapsulates _____.

- a. The life of sea creatures at the bottom of the sea
- b. How changes in the seasons are perceived by the deep-sea creatures
- c. The importance of having sensory receptors in order for creatures to survive
- d. The superiority of human beings over some creatures in terms of senses

21. In the preceding story, we discover that sea creatures _____.

- a. Live in darkness because no light reaches to the bottom
- b. Hear the sounds of the ocean
- c. Do not hear the sound of the sea as they are accustomed to it
- d. Unlike humans, do not possess senses of hearing and sight but they make use of other sensory organs to move within their environment

22. Sensory receptors allow us humans to perceive the beauty of nature which hugely differentiate us from other creatures.

- a. The statement is partly true
- b. The statement is false
- c. The statement is absolutely true
- d. The statement is incorrect



23. The earliest recorded syllables, considered as the most important advancement in the history of writing, were on tablets found in 2800 BC in the Sumerian city of _____.

- a. Mesopotamia
- b. Ur
- c. Babylon
- d. Babylonia

24. The Hindu belief that life is an illusion is referred to as

- a. dharma
- b. artha
- c. maya
- d. kama

25. Japanese women poets of the Manyoshu era were celebrated for their creativity and poetic expression. During the Heian Period (A.D. 794 – 1185), women were relegated to domestic roles as they were excluded from the political and economic arenas due to the influence of Buddhism and Confucianism. Yet women continued to be renowned for their lyrical poetry, known as Waka, which allow them to continue to excel in play a central role in the development of classical Japanese poetry through the phonetic alphabet Kana, or Onna Moji. Chinese poetry eventually gave way to Waka as the main form of Japanese poetry.

Based on the preceding narrative, mainstream Japanese poetry of the Heian period can best be described as _____.

- a. More refined than the poetry of the Manyoshu era
- b. Sentimental in nature and lyrical in style
- c. Written primarily for a female audience
- d. An outgrowth of Buddhism and Confucianism

26. In the preceding narrative, which of the following statements about Kana finds the least support in the passage?

- a. It was used in Japan after A.D. 793
- b. It was considered inappropriate for austere subject matter
- c. It was used primarily by Japanese women
- d. It was for Japanese poetry but not for Japanese prose

27. The author's primary purpose in the passage is to _____.

- a. Trace the influence of religion on the development of Japanese poetry
- b. Discredit the role of women in the development of Japanese poetry
- c. Provide an explanation for the role of women in the development of Japanese poetry
- d. Identify the reasons for the popularity of a distinct form of literary expression in Japan



28. During the Titanomachy, Zeus freed his brothers and sisters from their father, Cronus. As a result, the brothers and sisters gave Zeus the honor of being their leader, earning him the right to rule over the sky. What does this show about the Greeks?
- The Greeks value heroism
 - The Greeks value respect
 - The Greeks value honor
 - All of the above.
29. Modern Cosmology is a speculative science which examines the beginning of the universe. Modern cosmology includes the Big Bang Theory. In Greek mythology, the universe was said to have started with Chaos. Out of Chaos emerged Gaea, the goddess who represents the earth, Tartarus, representing the land of the dead, and Eros who represented desire. What can be said about the early Greeks regarding their belief about creation?
- The early Greeks understand the concept of creation.
 - The early Greeks associated creation in weaving stories of mythology.
 - The early Greeks understand the importance of understanding the logic of creation.
 - The early Greeks believe that creation is a product of mythology.
30. Birth, death and after life are constant stories in the mythologies of the world. What universal idea about life is reflected in using these motifs?
- That life has a beginning and an end
 - That life is a never ending cycle
 - That life is impermanent
 - That life is lived only once
31. The middle ages reflected these mythological creatures as symbol of purity. They are shown even in modern films as representation of love and beauty.
- Trolls
 - Dragons
 - Leprechauns
 - Unicorns
32. What sound device is exemplified in the first two lines of Edgar Allan Poe's 'The Raven'?
- Once upon a midnight dreary, while I pondered, weak and weary,
Over many a quaint and curious volume of forgotten lore—
While I nodded, nearly napping, suddenly there came a tapping,
As of someone gently rapping, rapping at my chamber door.
'Tis some visitor," I muttered, "tapping at my chamber door—
Only this and nothing more."*
- Anaphora
 - Onomatopoeia
 - Assonance
 - Alliteration



33. Which Greek goddess did Poe refer to in the lines

*But, with mien of lord or lady, perched above my chamber door—
Perched upon a bust of Pallas just above my chamber door—
Perched, and sat, and nothing more.*

- a. Diana
- b. Athena
- c. Hera
- d. Aphrodite

34. Juan Luna's famous painting The Spoliarium, which featured dying gladiators who are being dragged in by Roman soldiers into the basement of a Roman Amphitheatre to be stripped off their worldly possessions, inspired Jose Rizal to write this "Latin echo of the Spoliarium"

- a. El Filibusterismo
- b. Noli Mi Tangere
- c. Adios Patria Adorada
- d. Mi Ultimu Adios

35. The oldest surviving version of this Babylonian mythology dates back to Roman poet Ovid's Metamorphoses which was published in the 8th century AD and which was adapted by Shakespeare in Romeo and Juliet

- a. Pyramus and Thisbe
- b. Enuma Elish
- c. Bhagavad Gita
- d. Cupid and Psyche

36. The famous song, "Memory" from Andrew Lloyd Weber's musical Cats, was based on Old Possum's Book of Practical Cats by this American playwright, literary critic and editor, who is considered as the "father of modern poetry"

- a. Emily Dickinson
- b. John Steinbeck
- c. Thomas Stearns Elliot
- d. James Rusell

37. As a sign of her grief, Athena took the name of her childhood friend, the sea-god Triton's daughter whom she accidentally killed during a friendly sparring match. Who was this friend?

- a. Diana
- b. Doris
- c. Artemis
- d. Pallas



38. What do the following lines from Wadsworth Longfellow's A Psalm of Life reveal about heroes and heroism?

*Lives of great men all remind us
We can make our lives sublime,
And, departing, leave behind us
Footprints on the sands of time;*

- a. Anybody can be a hero.
- b. Heroes are often forgotten.
- c. Heroes are easy to find
- d. It is easy to do heroic acts.

39. What do the novels of Bronte, Eliot, Gaskell and Dickens reveal about fiction in the Victorian period of English Literature?

- a. They closely represent the social life of the times.
- b. The novels were long and full of psychological musings.
- c. They concentrate on the effect of industrialization on cities.
- d. They were largely produced by upper middle-class women.

40. What do the last two lines from Freneau's "The Wild Honeysuckle" reveal about life?

*From morning suns and evening dews
At first thy little being came;
If nothing once, you nothing lose,
For when you die you are the same;
The space between is but an hour,
The frail duration of flower.*

- a. Life is just an hour.
- b. Life is frail.
- c. Life is short.
- d. It is like a flower.

41. Who is alluded to as the Captain in the following lines from Walter Whitman's poem?

*O captain! My Captain!
Our fearful trip is done,
The ship has weather'd every rack,
the prize we sought is won.*

- a. Abraham Lincoln
- b. George Washington
- c. John F. Kennedy
- d. Thomas Jefferson

42. How does Shelley regard the west wind in Ode to the West Wind

*Her clarion o'er the dreaming earth,
and fill (Driving sweet buds like flocks to feed in air)
With living hues and odours plain and hill:
Wild Spirit, which art moving everywhere;
Destroyer and Preserver; hear, oh, hear!*

- a. It is responsible for preserving life.
- b. It can both wipe out and maintain life.
- c. It is a wild spirit in nature that is very strong.
- d. It is strong but weak since it is everywhere.

43. How does the speaker picture God in the following sermon?

The God that holds you over the pit of hell, much as one holds a spider; or some loathsome insect, over the fire, abhors you, and is dreadfully provoked: his wrath towards you burns like fire; he looks upon you as worthy of nothing else, but to be cast into the fire; he is of purer eyes than to bear to have you in his sight; you are ten thousand times more abominable in his eyes, than the most hateful venomous serpent is in ours. [Sinners in the Hands of an Angry God, 1741]

- a. incensed
- b. abominable
- c. assertive
- d. vengeful

44. Paradise Lost, John Milton's epic poem in blank verse, tells the biblical tale of

- a. the struggle of humankind
- b. Judas Iscariot's treachery of Jesus
- c. the passion of Christ
- d. the temptation of Adam and Eve and their banishment from the Garden of Eden

45. What does the speaker like about Chicago as shown in the following lines?

*Come and show me another city with lifted head singing
so proud to be alive and coarse and strong and cunning.
Flinging magnetic curses amid the toil of piling
job on job, here is a tall bold slugger
set vivid against the little soft cities;*

- a. Its vitality
- b. Its wickedness
- c. Its indifference
- d. Its progress



46. Recall Thomas Paine's "The Crisis". Who did the writer allude to in the line "the summer soldier and the sunshine patriot"?

These are the times that try men's souls. The summer soldier and the sunshine patriot will, in this crisis, shrink from the service of their country; but he that stands it now, deserves the love and thanks of man and woman.

- a. The cowards who love their country less
- b. The brave men and women who fought in the war
- c. The former heroes of the revolution
- d. People who had supported independence before the war but changed their minds once it began

47. What does that the speaker lament over in the following lines from Romeo and Juliet?
"What's in a name? That which we call a rose by any other name would smell as sweet".

- a. Calling a rose by any other name does not its nature
- b. Their names keep Romeo and Juliet apart.
- c. Romeo and Juliet will always love one another.
- d. Changing names will help Romeo and Juliet.

48. What do the following lines below from Shakespeare's "As You Like It, Act II, Scene VII" reveal about life?

"All the world's a stage, and all the men and women merely players.

They have their exits and their entrances; And one man in his time plays many parts"

- a. Life is just like going to the theater.
- b. People have different roles to play in life.
- c. Life is but an empty, senseless dream.
- d. People live and die at different times.

49. What truth about humans do the following lines from "A Noiseless Patient Spider" reveal?

And you, O my Soul, where you stand,

Surrounded, surrounded, in measureless oceans of space,

Ceaselessly musing, venturing, throwing,--seeking the spheres, to connect them;

Till the bridge you will need, be form'd--till the ductile anchor hold;

Till the gossamer thread you fling, catch somewhere, O my Soul.

- a. People need food and shelter
- b. People search for their meaning
- c. People need friends and families
- d. People endlessly seek to create

50. Which of the following is not an example of Gothic literature?

- a. Dracula
- b. Frankenstein
- c. Tell Tale Heart
- d. Lord of the Rings

